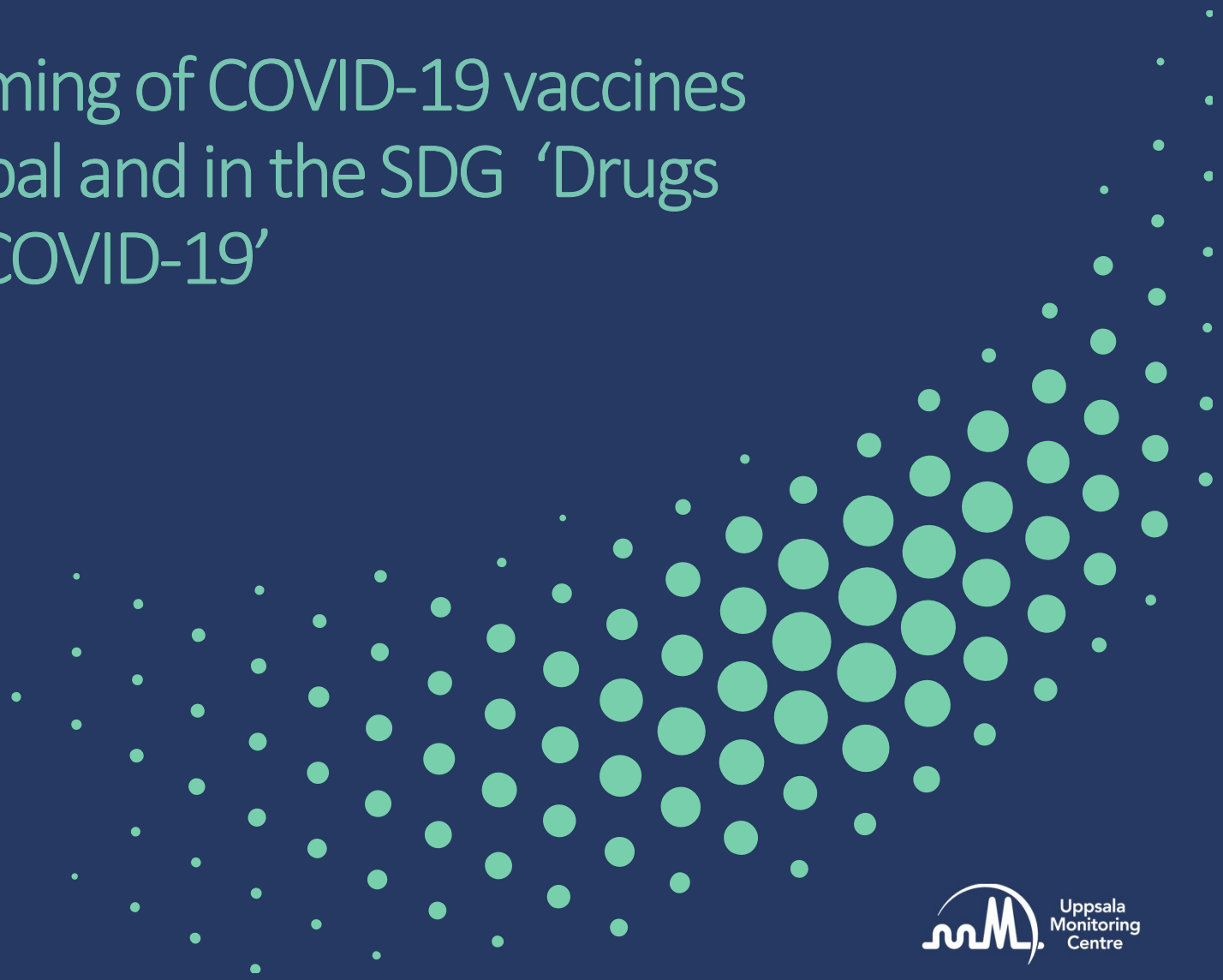
Structure and naming of COVID-19 vaccines in WHODrug Global and in the SDG 'Drugs and vaccines for COVID-19'

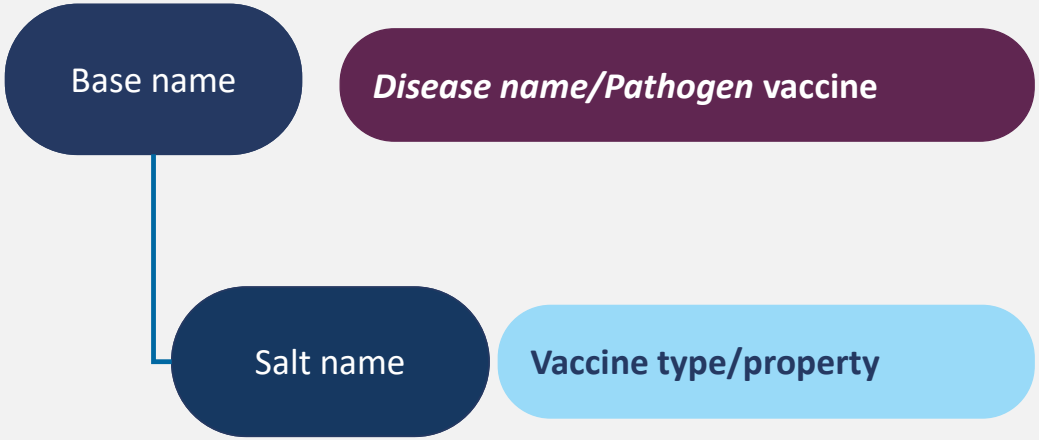


Uppsala Monitoring Centre

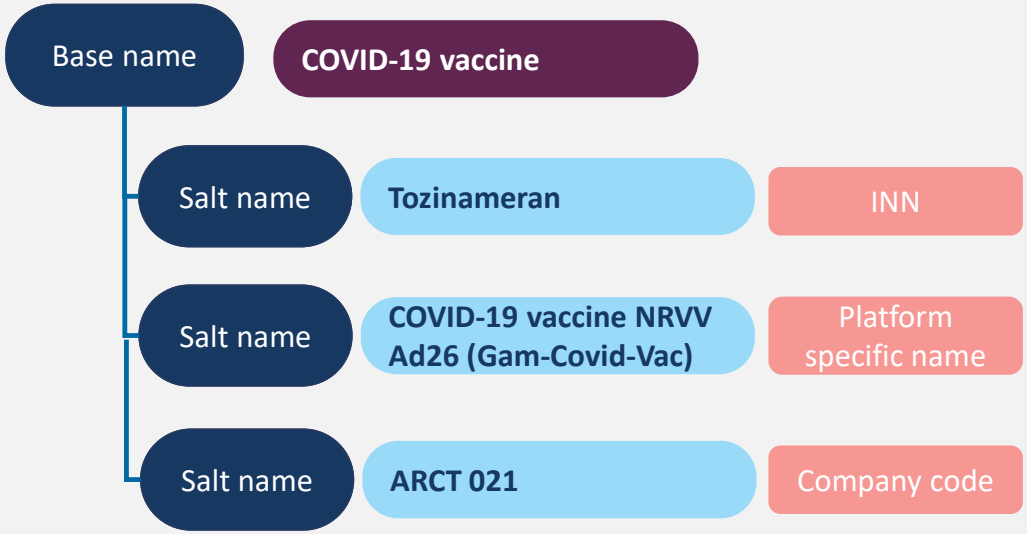
Structure of vaccine substances in WHODrug

The general vaccine structure in WHODrug is hierarchical. The hierarchy starts with the preferred base name, described as the disease/pathogen + the word vaccine, for example BCG vaccine.

Vaccine variants are connected to the base name and they describe various vaccine types or properties, depending on vaccine type.



Uppsala Monitoring Centre



COVID-19 vaccines structure in WHODrug

The COVID-19 vaccines follow the general WHODrug vaccine nomenclature: all vaccines types are connected as variants (salts) to the vaccine base name.

COVID-19 vaccine substances names, should preferably be an International Nonproprietary Name (INN) (https://www.thelancet.com/journals/lancet/article/PIIS0140-6736(21)00099-4/fulltext)

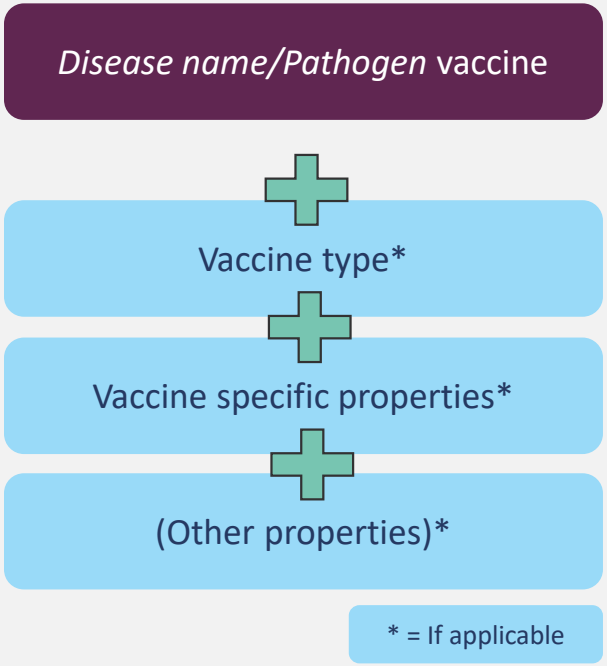
Apart from the INN, specific platform-based names or company codes can also be used by themselves or as synonyms. The platform-based names are based on the platforms from the WHO draft-landscape-of-covid-19-candidate-vaccines

Uppsala Monitoring Centre

COVID-19 vaccine *platform names*

Specific platform-based names can also be used to identify vaccines substances types in WHODrug by themselves or as synonyms. The platform-based names are based on the platforms from the WHO draft-landscape-of-covid-19-candidate-vaccines

Specific platform-based names contain information about vaccine type and, if available, vaccine specific properties and other properties.



Uppsala Monitoring Centre

Examples of COVID-19 vaccine platform names

General WHODrug vaccine nomenclature structure

Disease name/Pathogen vaccine

+

Vaccine type*

+

Vaccine specific properties*

+

(Other properties)*

* = If applicable

Example 1: COVID-19 vaccine NRVV Ad26 (Gam-Covid-Vac)

COVID-19 vaccine

+

NRVV

+

Ad26

+

(Gam-Covid-Vac)

Example 2: COVID-19 vaccine mRNA (BNT162b2)

COVID-19 vaccine

+

mRNA

+

Not applicable

+

(BNT162b2)

Uppsala Monitoring Centre

Nomenclature for COVID-19 vaccines *products*

COVID-19 vaccine products are included in WHODrug after approval by regulatory authorities.

Their inclusion in the dictionary does not account for differences in approval e.g. limited, emergency use or a full approval.

Uppsala Monitoring Centre

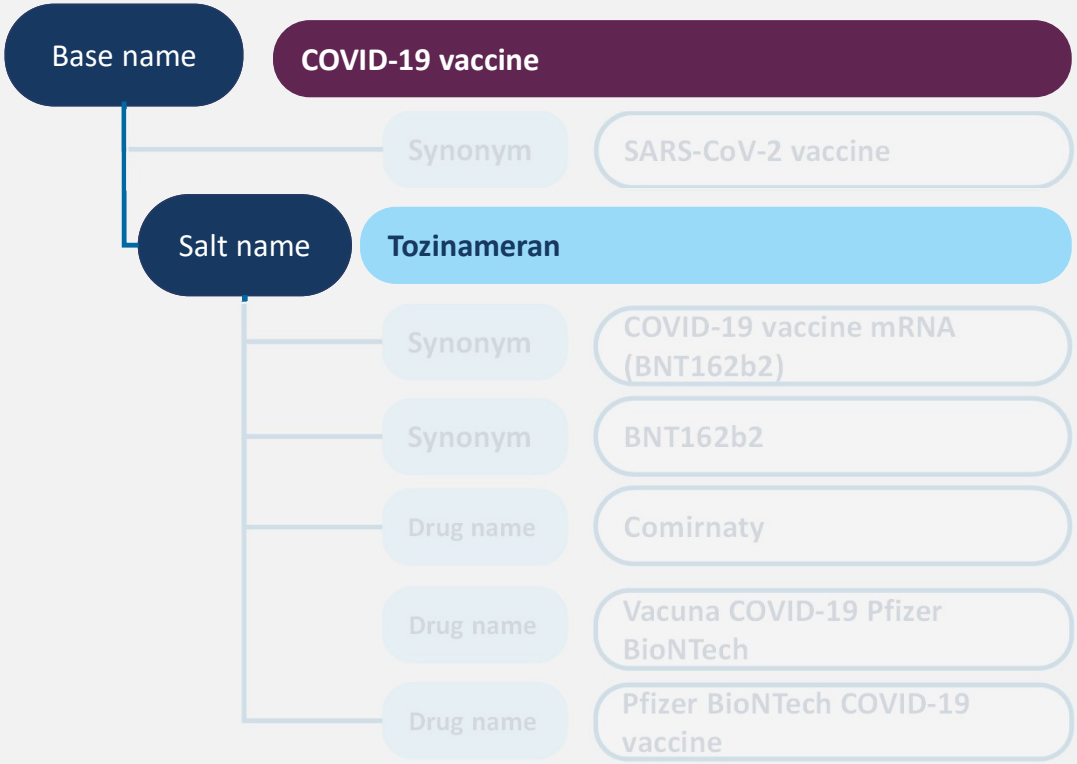
Example: nomenclature for Tozinameran

Uppsala Monitoring Centre

Example: nomenclature for Tozinameran

Tozinameran is an example of COVID-19 vaccine *substance* included from version 1 March 2021 of WHODrug Global.

Tozinameran is included as a variation (preferred salt name) to the base COVID-19 vaccine.

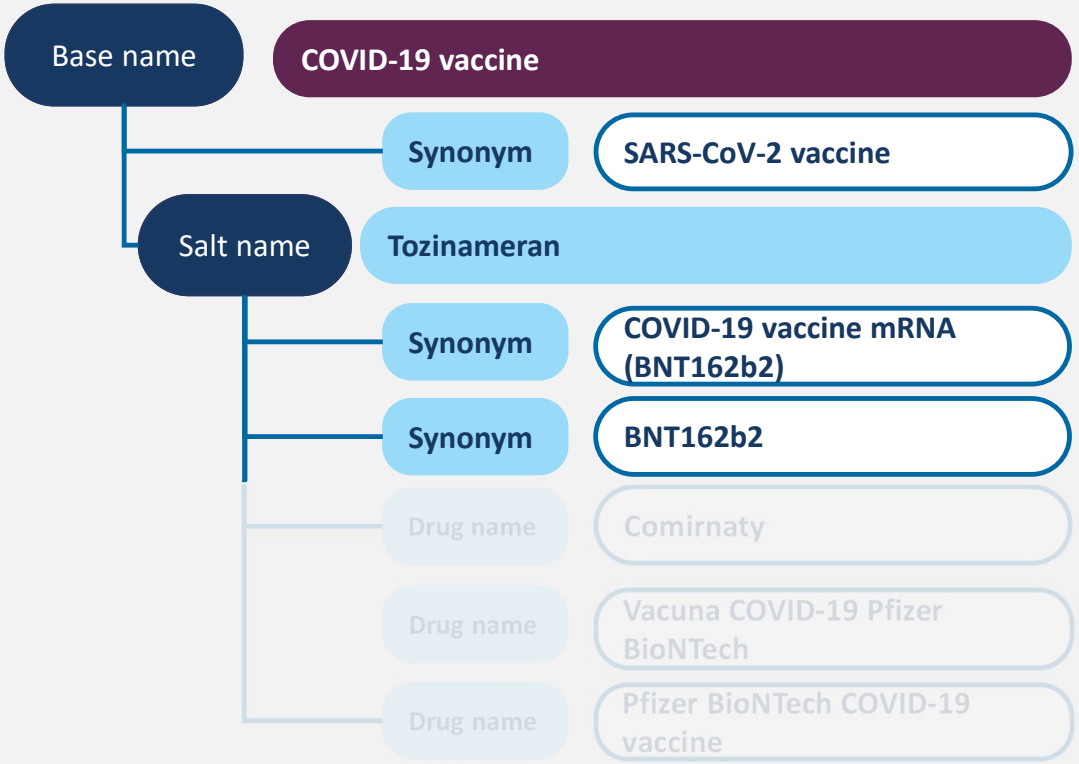


Uppsala Monitoring Centre

Example: nomenclature for Tozinameran

Tozinameran is an official INN name.

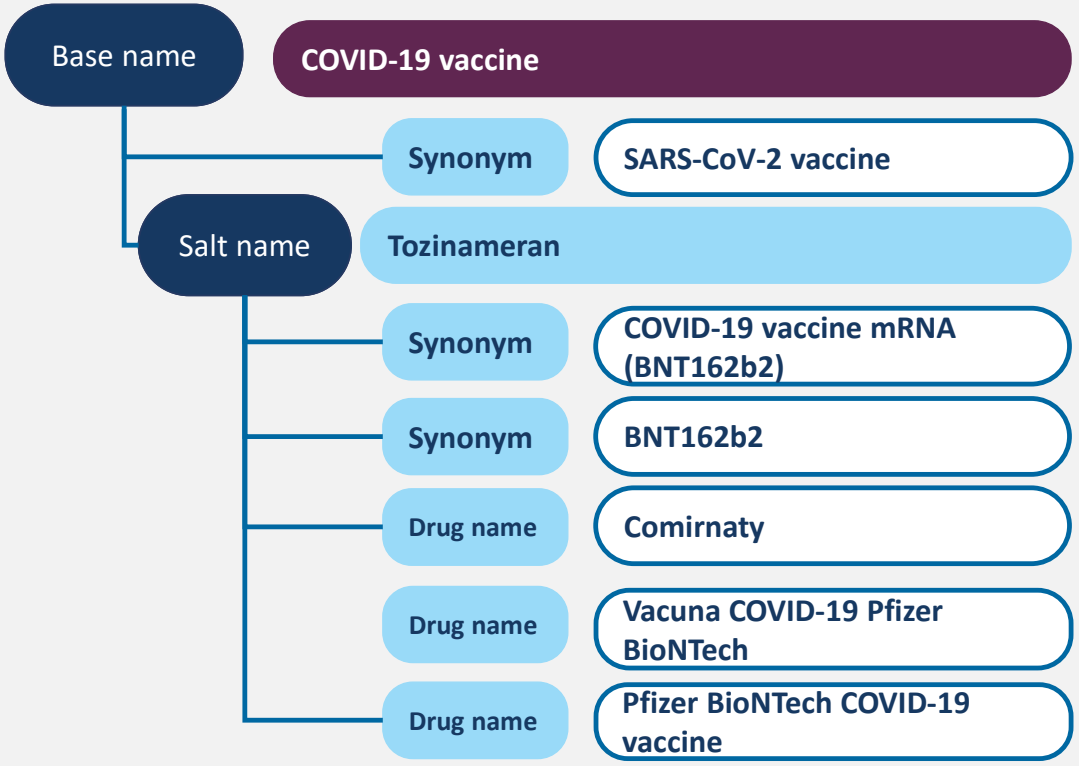
Applicable platform-based names and company codes for tozinameran are included as synonyms.



Uppsala Monitoring Centre

Example: nomenclature for Tozinameran

Medicinal products approved by regulatory authorities and containing the COVID-19 substance Tozinameran are included in WHODrug (Drug names).



Uppsala Monitoring Centre

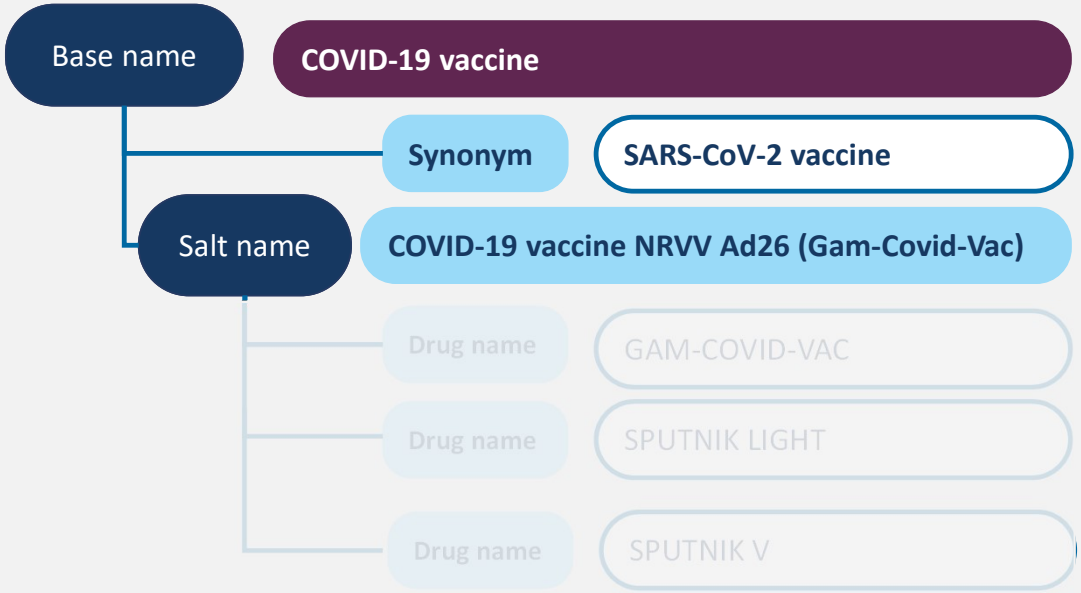
Example: nomenclature for COVID-19 vaccine NRVV Ad26 (Gam-Covid-Vac)

Uppsala Monitoring Centre

Example: nomenclature for COVID-19 vaccine NRVV Ad26 (Gam-Covid-Vac)

COVID-19 vaccine NRVV Ad26 (Gam-Covid-Vac) is an example of COVID-19 vaccine *substance* included from version 1 March 2021 of WHODrug Global.

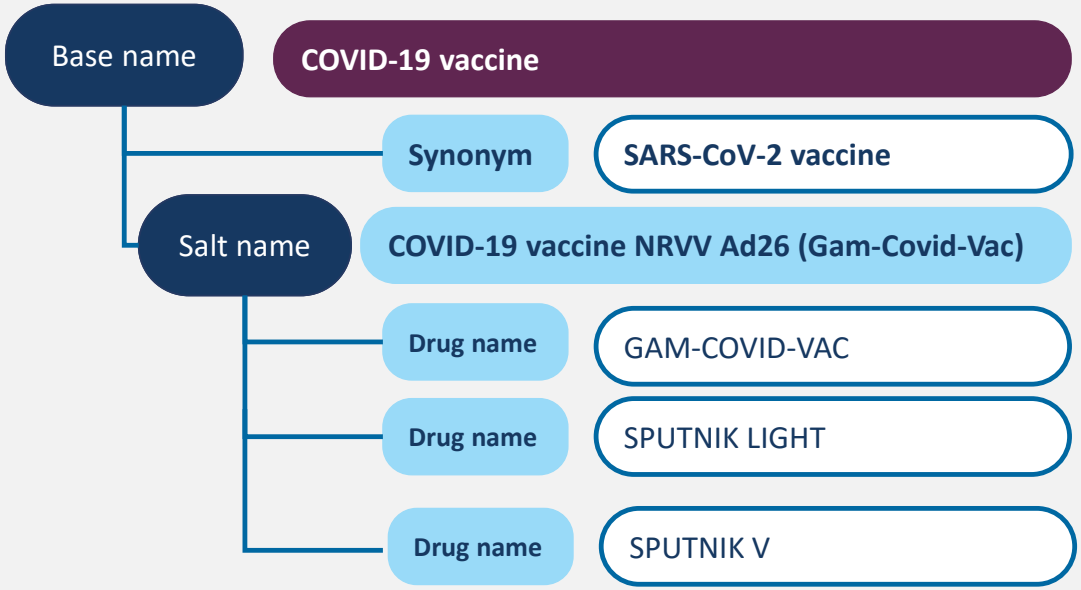
COVID-19 vaccine NRVV Ad26 (Gam-Covid-Vac) is included as a variation (preferred salt name) to the base COVID-19 vaccine .



Uppsala Monitoring Centre

Example: nomenclature for COVID-19 vaccine NRVV Ad26 (Gam-Covid-Vac)

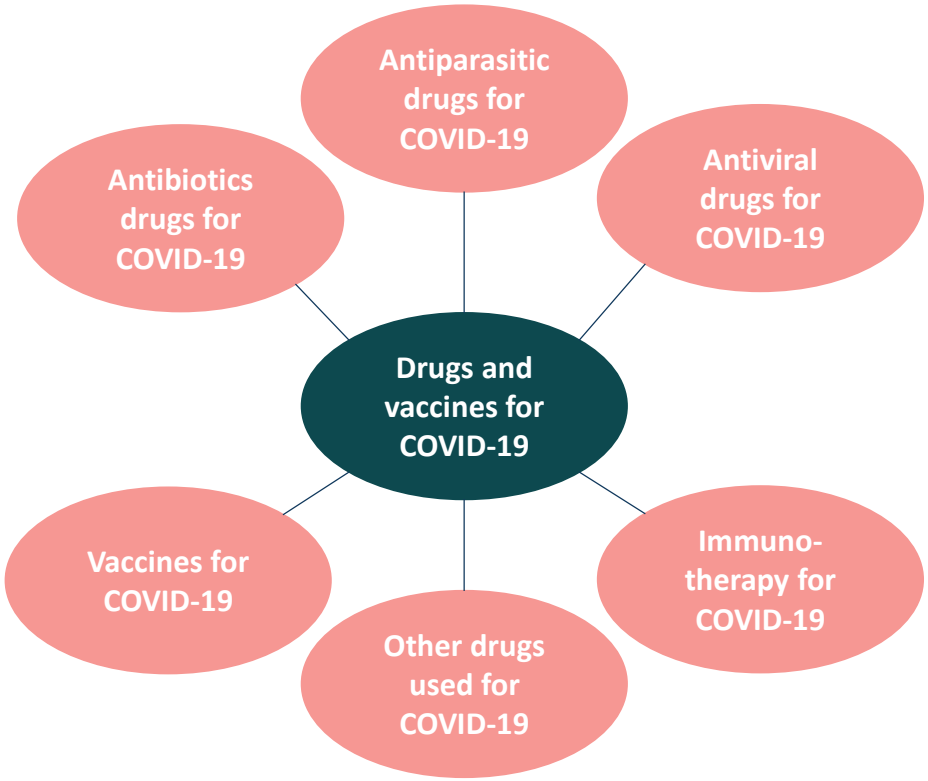
Medicinal products approved by regulatory authorities containing the COVID-19 substance COVID-19 vaccine NRVV Ad26 (Gam-Covid-Vac) are included in WHODrug (Drug name).



Uppsala Monitoring Centre

WHODrug Standardised Drug Grouping (SDG) 'Drugs and vaccines for COVID-19'

Uppsala Monitoring Centre



SDG

SDG subgroup level 1

SDG - Drugs and vaccines for COVID-19

This SDG includes approved drugs, repurposed drugs or drugs in clinical trials used for the treatment of COVID-19, with no regards to regulatory status (i.e. label vs off label).

(Link to the WHODrug SDG User Guide)

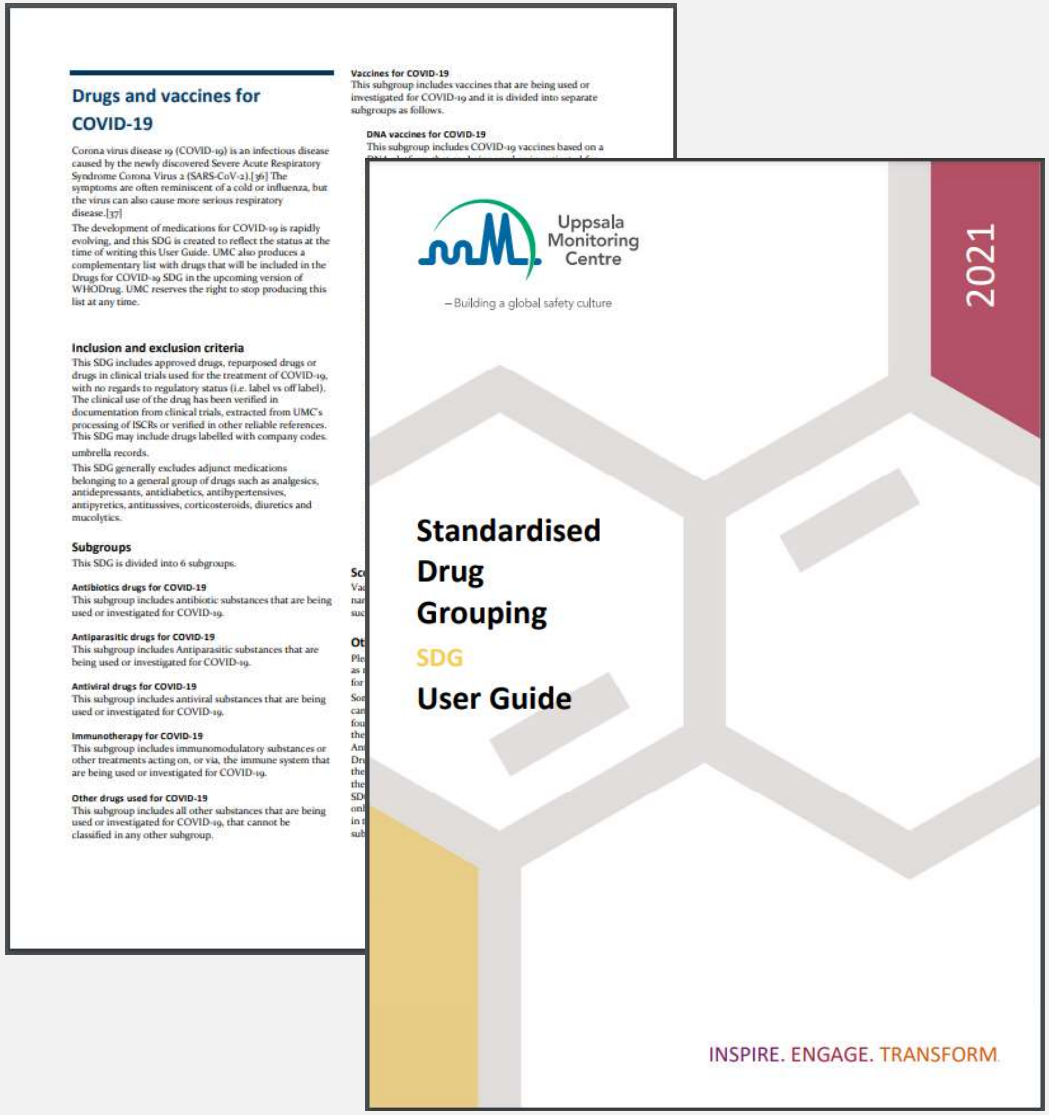
Uppsala Monitoring Centre

SDG - Drugs and vaccines for COVID-19

References for inclusion in SDG:

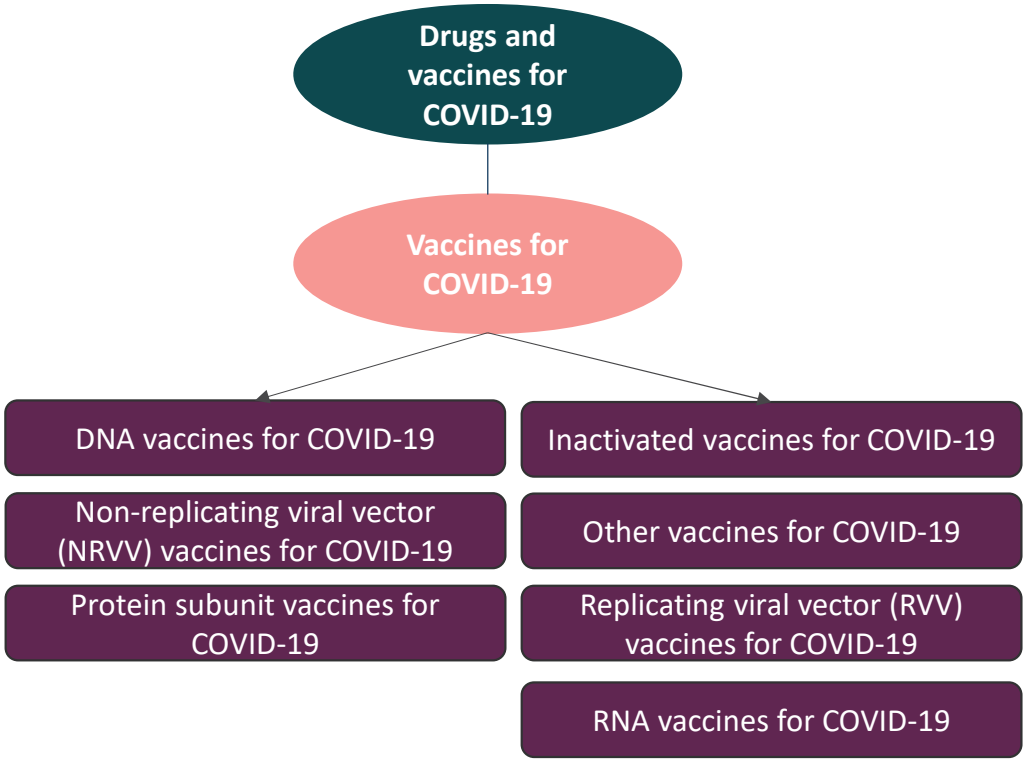
- Clinical trials, continuously scanned, different governmental sites
- Individual Case Safety Reports (ICSR)
- Customer requests
- Other e.g. scientific journals

(Link to the WHODrug SDG User Guide)



Uppsala Monitoring Centre

SDG - Drugs and vaccines for COVID-19



- SDG
- SDG subgroup level 1
- SDG subgroup level 2

The ‘**Vaccines for COVID-19**’ subgroup (level 1) is divided in seven subgroups (level 2) based on based on the platforms found in the [WHO draft-landscape-of-covid-19-candidate-vaccines]

Uppsala Monitoring Centre

Useful links

WHODrug User Guide version 5.0

https://www.who-umc.org/user-area/whodrug/full-whodrug-library/whodrug-user-guide-current-version/

WHODrug SDG User Guide version 1 March 2021

https://www.who-umc.org/user-area/whodrug/full-whodrug-library/whodrug-sdg-user-guide/

WHO draft-landscape-of-COVID-19-candidate-vaccines

https://www.who.int/publications/m/item/draft-landscape-of-covid-19-candidate-vaccines

Uppsala Monitoring Centre

Making medicines **safer for patients**

Uppsala Monitoring Centre (UMC)
Box 1051, SE-751 40 Uppsala, Sweden
Email: info@who-umc.org, www.who-umc.org

Uppsala Monitoring Centre